AstroTaca Flat Panel · Quick start

Pre-release draft · Windows software 3.2.2

The product is still in development. No public installer is available yet. Use the confirmed mounting instructions and approved power supply for your unit; final product specifications are still pending.

1. Install and connect

1. Once available, download Setup from AstroTaca Releases. Close NINA and AstroTaca windows, then run Setup. Approve the administrator prompt when asked.
2. If Setup asks, choose **Install ASCOM Platform** and follow its window. AstroTaca Setup continues when ASCOM is ready.
3. Connect the panel with a **USB data cable** and its approved **12 V DC supply**. USB alone cannot power movement or light. Keep the cover's path clear.
4. Open **AstroTaca Flat Panel** from Start or the desktop. If asked, choose its **USB port** and **Save**, then choose **Connect**. The port is remembered.
5. If calibration is requested, follow the calibration guide before using the controls. Check the actual Closed and Open positions with the movement area clear.

2. Choose your controls

In the AstroTaca app: choose **Close** and wait for **Closed**. Select a low brightness with the slider, then choose **Turn on / apply**. Moving the slider alone does not change the light. Choose **Light off** when finished.

In NINA: go to **Equipment → Flat Panel**, select **AstroTaca Flat Panel (ASCOM)** and connect. Its settings gear lets you choose the USB port. Choose **Close**, wait for **Closed**, then enter a low, nonzero brightness and choose **Set** to turn on the light at that level. Use NINA's light control to switch it off when finished.

Close first, then light on. A light request never closes the cover for you. Opening switches the light off. The two apps can share a connection; disconnecting only the AstroTaca app leaves NINA connected. Keep manual controls idle during an automated sequence.

3. Use the button

Press	Result
Quick tap	Open or close; stop if already moving.
Hold about **1 second, then release**	While Closed: **Off → Dim → Medium → Bright → Off**.
Hold **3 seconds**	Stop and turn the light off while still holding.

While Closed, use the app's **Button settings** to set your three levels and choose **Save to panel**. **Dim is your usual starting brightness.** Presets stay saved without power and work without a computer. Powering on does not turn on the light.

The motor does not keep holding the cover after a move or Stop. Make sure it is supported so it cannot fall. Keep hands clear during powered movement.

Full manual, opening limits and troubleshooting · Ask for help